

settings. When a user installs a new program or the configuration settings are otherwise altered, the values of these keys change. If viruses modify these keys, they can produce damaging effects.

Logic Bomb

A logic bomb is a type of trojan horse that executes when specific conditions occur. Triggers for logic bombs can include a change in a file, by a particular series of keystrokes, or at a specific time or date. See also: Time Bomb

Macro

A macro is a series of instructions designed to simplify repetitive tasks within a program such as Microsoft Word, Excel or Access. Macros execute when a user opens the associated file. Microsoft's latest macro programming language is simple to use, powerful, and not limited to Word documents. Macros are mini-programs and can be infected by viruses. See also: Macro Virus

Macro Virus

A macro virus is a malicious macro. Macro viruses are written a macro programming language and attach to a document file (such as Word or Excel). When a document or template containing the macro virus is opened in the target application, the virus runs, does its damage and then copies itself into other documents. Continual use of the program results in the spread of the virus.

Mail Bomber

Software that floods a victim's inbox with hundreds or thousands of mails. Such mail generally does not correctly reveal its source.

Mailbomb

Excessively large e-mail (typically many thousands of messages) or many large messages sent to a user's e-mail account, for the purpose of crashing the system, or preventing genuine messages from being received.